



# HOW TO FULL PLANCHE

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# THE PLANCHE

The planche is one of the most common strength skills you can see in calisthenics nowadays. The path of learning it is long and thought so you need to prepare yourself with lot of patience and positive attitude. To make the progress smooth and avoid injuries you must be familiar with the most essential information and you must follow proper training program. In this e-book I want to share with you my training methods based on my 7 years planche experience. This approach helped many athletes around the world.





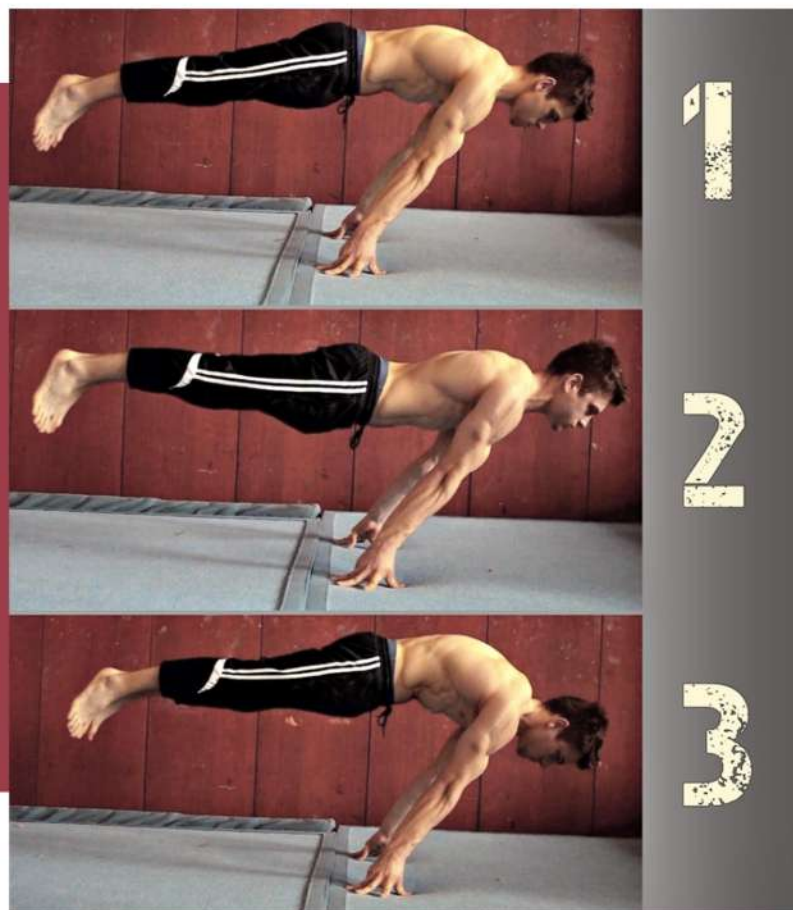
## Basic requirements

The people often rush and neglect the requirements. I highly recommend at least one year of calisthenics experience before ever trying the planche. Good level at all basic exercises is a must. Especially the ones building push strength like push-ups, dips. Handstand is optional, but it will help strengthen the shoulders, the core and the whole upper body.

Before ever trying planche I had already 1 year of handstand experience. I was able to do 20 handstand push-ups, 20+ pull ups, 40+ dips. This gave me enough strength to go faster through the first steps of the planche. Of course that is not an obligational level, but I mention it just as reference

## Planche technique

First, I will cover this topic because it is one of the most important things you need to understand from the beginning. Although many people recommend doing hollow body position during performing planche, few people give definition of what this really means.



In 2017, I posted a photo asking my followers what planche form do they like the most.

Most of the people in the comments voted for planche 1 and planche 3. Many argued that planche 3 is the correct gymnastic form. They claimed that this is the real hollow body and many still do. But is this true?

## 1 Planche in gymnastics

In gymnastics hollow body form is not a factor. Judges look only at whether the body is horizontal and the elbows straight. Which is another drawback because many gymnasts use that fact to cheat. They lock and touch the triceps to the chest which makes the static element way easier. But that according to the rules of gymnastics is correct, as long as the body is horizontal and the elbows locked.



## 2 Planche in calisthenics

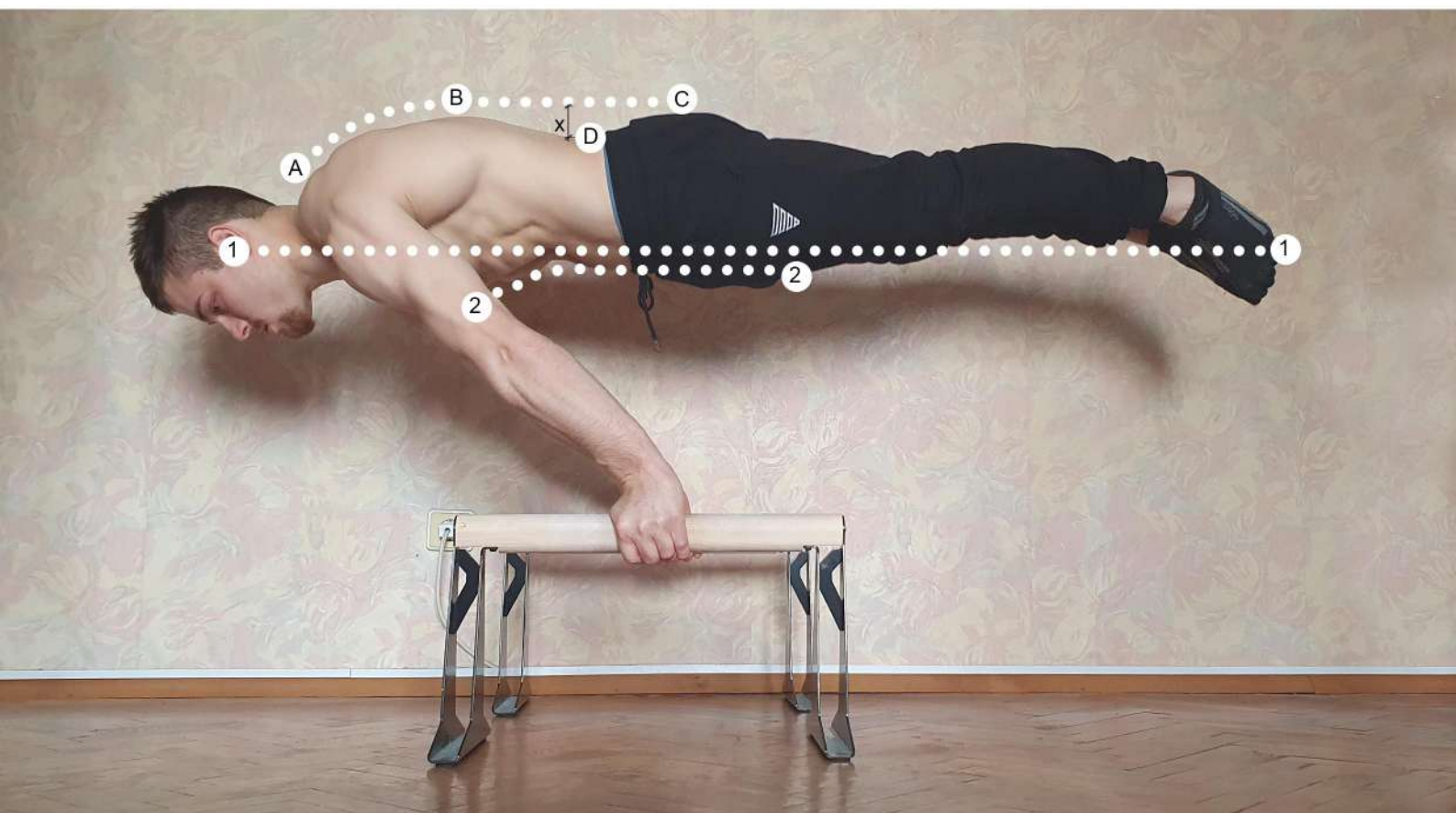
But what about calisthenics? Unfortunately, we do not have any rules how a planche must be performed. That is why every athlete executes the elements by different technique, thinking and claiming that this is the only correct way. Usually people who are not strong enough go for planche 3, or use a lock while doing planche 2, because it is easier. Will cover those cases later.

That is why in this e-book by correct form I will mean the form that is the most difficult (when the body is longest), the safest (with the minimal risk of injuries.) and the most enjoyable to watch. Such a form is 1.



### 3 Proper planche technique

All the photos are made with perpendicular faced to the body camera. That is the only angle where the form can be seen the best, without having any deviations.



#### 3.1. Hollow body.

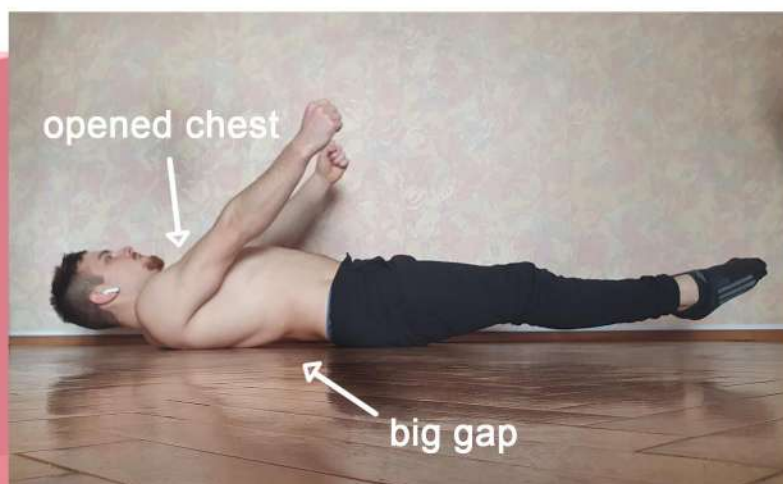
What is the secret? The answer is simple. It is all about pushing the shoulders forward. Forget all the complex explanation for excessive hollow body, because most of the time that leads to over protraction(planche 3), which makes the skill much easier than the straight form, something that will cover later.

As a result, you will achieve 3 things:

The line A-B will be slightly curved.

The shoulder should be on the line 1-1. This line must be around the level of the lower contour of the stomach and legs or just a little bit above it

The lower contour of your body between the stomach and the chest should follow line 2-2



**Incorrect form**

To feel and understand what I mean, lie down on the floor, raise the hands so that an angle Y is obtained, and then just push the shoulders forward. This will automatically hide the chest and will make that highly desired hollow body form without any excessive hollow body.



**Proper form**

### 3.2. Head.

Focus your gaze vertically down or even down the feet. Don't look forward. Looking forward will automatically open the chest and spoil the hollow.

### 3.3. The butt and the waist.

Many people do not activate that part. Often the butt goes way above the waist when an athlete does not squeeze it. In this case the waist will fall and will make the "banana" form of the planche. In this scenario the shoulder will take most of the tension, which is not recommended. Instead, try to tighten the butt and push it forward. By this way, the distance x (photo at page 5) will be smaller (the smaller, the better). Of course it's almost impossible the lower back to be on the same level as your butt unless you have really, really small butt :D

To feel it get the best out of it, lie down with your back facing the floor and try to tighten the butt. The idea is to reduce the gap between the waist and the floor. In the correct position, the waist should be as close as possible to the ground. To do almost straight line, think of point B to be on the level of point C. And point D to be as close as possible to the line BC by using the butt squeeze technique.



### 3.4. The hips

Although they are not that important for the planche, the hips are tightened during the planche performance. You can notice that the best after a heavy leg day, when you will have difficulty with the planche execution due to a problem with leg tightness.

### 3.5. The hamstring flexibility

Play a major role in the vision of the planche. The better hamstring flexibility you have the more beautiful your planche will be. That is why for people with very poor flexibility, I suggest stretching before and after the training.



### 3.6. Pointing the toes.

Few people pay attention to this. Pointing toes is widely considered to be something gymnastic and some people think it only contributes to creating better straight line. But in fact, there is something else. When pointing the toes, tightening the waist and butt becomes a bit harder compared to the exactly opposite 90 degrees toes. This is also the reason some calisthenics athletes when they are tired to end up their competition set use contra pointet toes. It often even becomes unconscious. The difference is small.



**Pointed toes**



**Contra pointed toes**



### 3.7. Elbows.

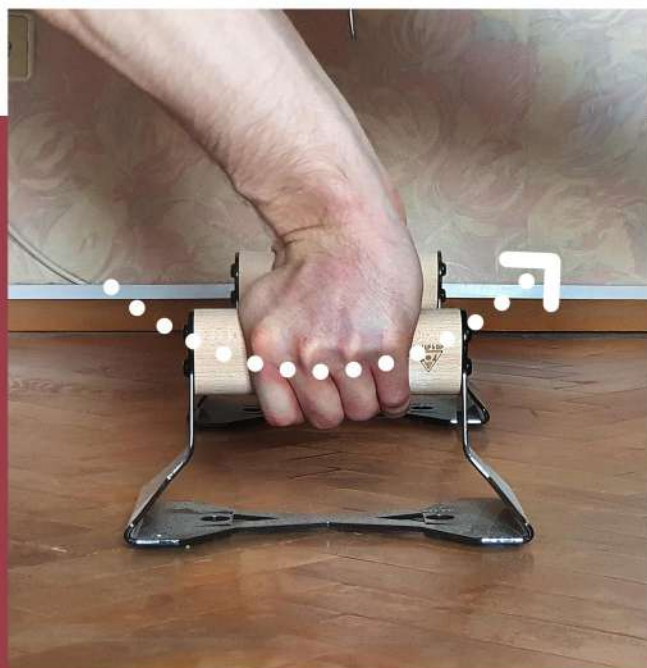
Should always be straight. Try to turn the elbows out. Flexibility is also very important for more beautiful performance. It usually gets better with practice. Now my elbows are overextended but 7 year ago they were less flexible.

### 3.8. Wrists.

There are big differences depending on which grip you use. I recommend every beginner to start with the easiest grip. For 70% of the people it is on parallel bars. Push the wrist to the direction shown in the photos. This will keep your shoulder and your planche high.



Turn the elbows out



Push on parallel bars



Push on floor

## 4 Planche height

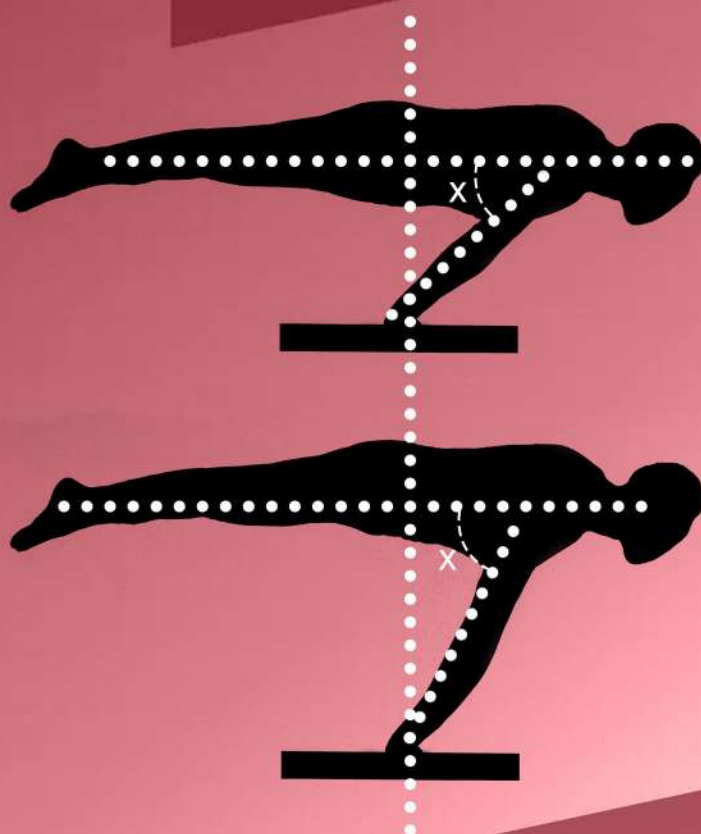
The planche height plays a big role for the overall planche look. It depends on the angle  $x$ , which is determined by two things:

### 4.1. Level of strength.

One of the reasons for low planche is when the athlete is not strong enough to lift his legs and must lean forward more than necessary. Usually people with this type of low planche go for planche 3.

### 4.2. The length ratio of the body and hands.

In any case, the wrists should be below the center of gravity point. It is usually in the same axis as the navel. Even if you are very strong, but you have short arms your angle  $x$  will be small, therefore your planche will be low. Conversely, if the arms are proportionally much longer than the body, the angle will be larger and the planche higher. All this is about people with normal physics. In the case of the disabled, the center of gravity point is most often shifted higher towards the chest, which explains why their planche is much higher and less leaned than normal.

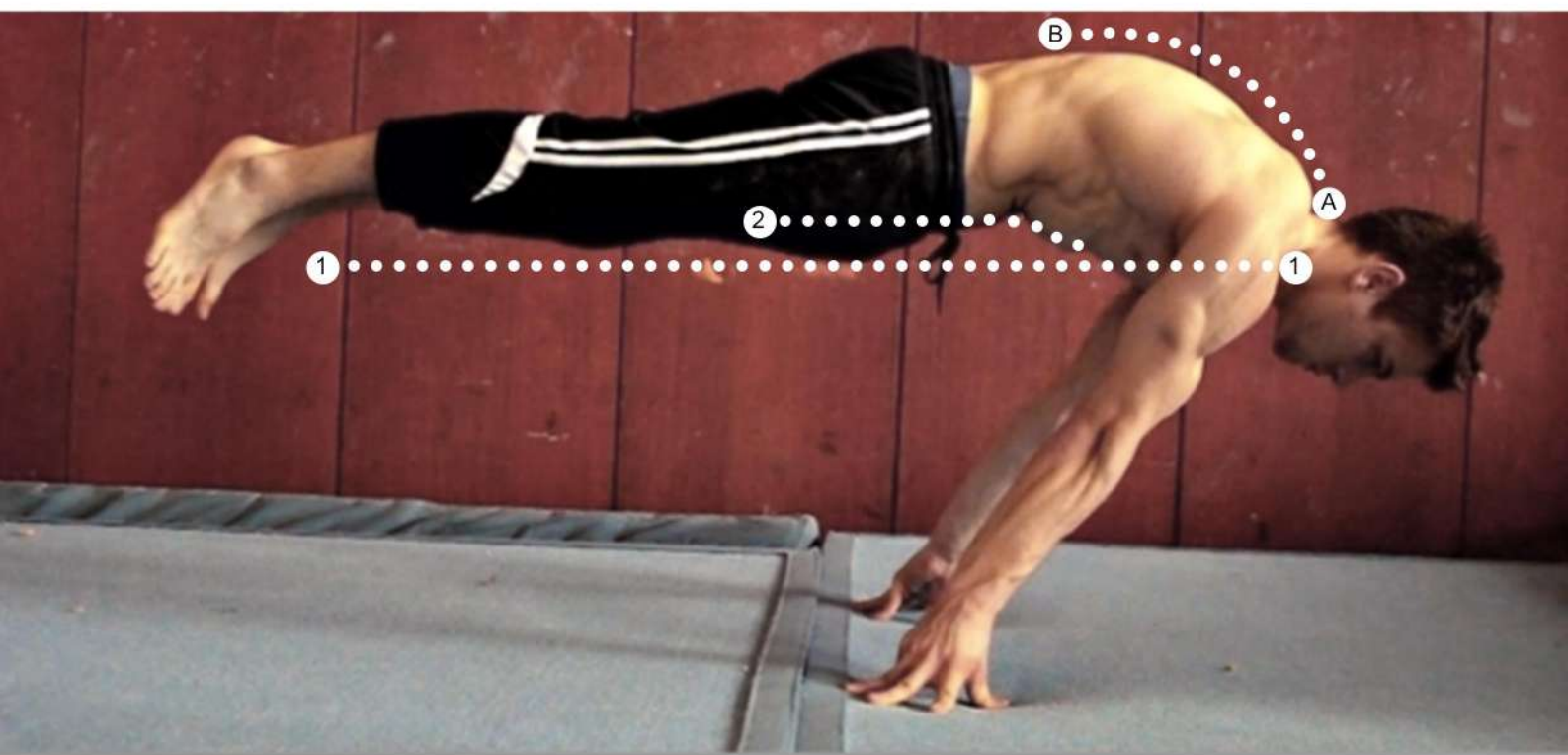




## 5 Incorrect planche techniques

### 5.1. Planche 3 . Overexposed hollowbody

Usually athletes performing the planche by this technique are protracting too much and hold their back high. They claim that that their planche is high, but in fact the shoulders are still low. As you can see the line 1 is positioned way under the body. Also the curved part is longer (including all the back and even lower back) This planch gives you more time until you fall. The body gets significantly shorter, which is also a plus for the hold. This position is much easier to be combined into combos with presses and push-ups.

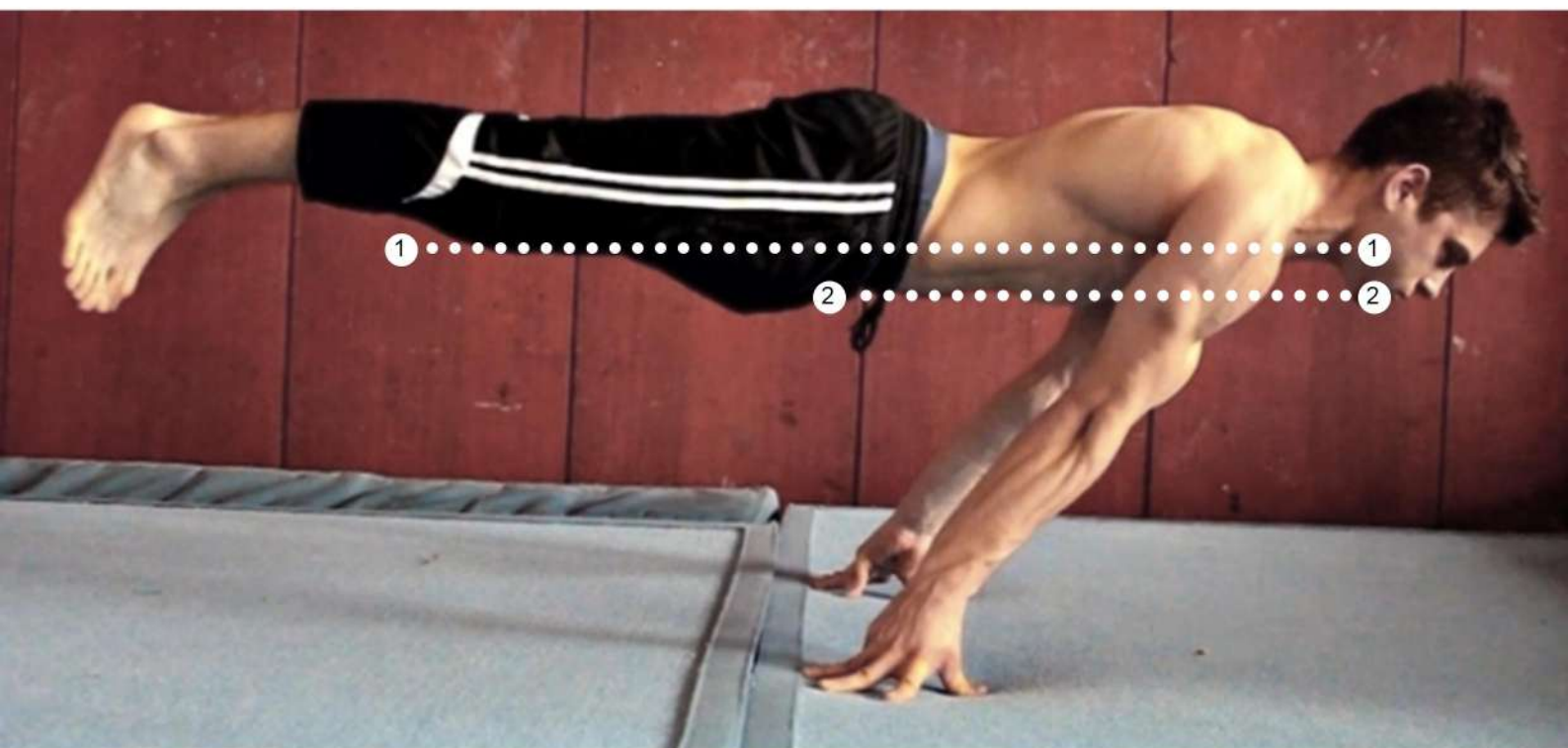


However, I do not say this planche is wrong. Exactly because it is easier, I have included it in the program. Beginners can do that form while gradually straighten the body and go for planche 1.

## 5.2. Planche 2. "Banana" form of the planche.

In this technique there is no hollow body position and the chest is opened. Often it is performed without tightening the butt and the waist. The risk of injury is greatest because all the weight goes to the shoulder.

In this planche, the possibility of cheat is much greater. As I said we often see athletes touching their big chest to their hands. It is not beautiful.



I do not recommend this technique to anybody. This planche engages the muscles in a much different way than planche 1 and planche 3. It is also very difficult to put into combination. Once you learn this way, it will be hard to understand the hollow body position.

Even from the beginning try to push the shoulders forward. Hollow body with thank you even more in the future since it will make all the planche combos and transitions easier.



## ⑥ Sign of weaknesses.

The body parts that are mostly involved in the planche are the shoulders and the lower back. Usually one of the two is weaker. According to that there are 2 types of weaknesses with 2 distinct planche performances

### 6.1. A weak shoulder and a strong waist.

Usually leads to straightly horizontal low planche. Often happens the form M on the back appears.



### 6.2. A strong shoulder and a weak lower back.

Leads to low waist position and high shoulder. The shoulder is the most vulnerable, because all the pressure goes there.

In order to be strong everywhere, each body part should be trained simultaneously from the beginning. That is why in each program I have added basic exercise for both parts.

# Way of training

In this chapter I will explain the main structure of a regular planche day. I also cover the way of execution, the number of attempts and the time of rest. All the exercises are included in the program.

In the chapter "Program" I clarify each level which exercises includes and in what sequence must be performed.

Every training is divided into 4 parts: Warm up, Specific warm up, Planche attempts, Planche base

## 1 Warm up

Nothing different than a whole body regular warm up. Since you have some calisthenics experience you already know that part. 10-15 minutes are enough.

## 2 Planche warm up.

For sure normal warming up will help, but your progress will be much faster and safer if you include specific planche warm up

### 2.1. Why you need to do it?

The main idea is to simulate the exercise, to feel the same type pressure but lighter. By this way, the risk of injury is highly reduced, because the muscles and tendons will be prepared for the planche tension. I also want to note that the quality of exercise will be much greater after such a specific warm-up. I always have slight pain before warming up and it is quite painful to perform any complicated exercise. It is important to keep warming up till this pain is gone. Better hear the crackling, creaking of your arms and shoulders during that warm up, rather than during the real attempts.

### 2.2. How much time it will take?

This second warm up will take around 5-10 minutes.

### 2.3. How much sets and reps?

Do as much as it will not exhaust you for the training. Usually 3-4 attempts of each exercise is enough.



## 2.4. Exercises included in the planche warm up

### 2.4.1. Shoulder push-ups. 1

Transition between a retracted and protracted position. Think about how you open and close the chest while pushing with the shoulders. Do not bend the elbows. I recommend no more than 10 reps in a single try.



### 2.4.2. Rubber band pulling. 2

Using the shoulder forward technique all the time. Use a lightweight rubber band that will allow you to do 10 reps in a single try without exhausting you.



### 2.4.3. Planche leans. 3

Performed with the planche technique, try to push the shoulders forward and lean as much as possible, while your feet stand on the ground. Be careful not to overdo the hollow body, no need for that in the planche leans.  4



Proper lean



Incorrect lean

## 3 Planche attempts

**3.1. How many attempts?** Do the attempts till you cannot perform properly the exercises and minimum 3 attempts

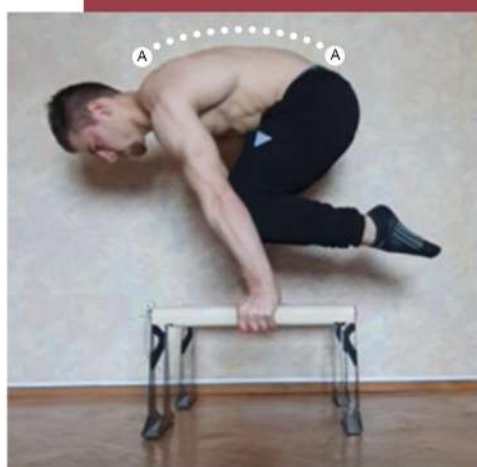
**3.2. How much rest between the attempts?** Rest as much as it allows you to perform the exercises properly. Usually 2-3 minutes is enough.

### 3.3. Exercises included in the program

#### Main progressions

I show you the main 10 progressions. I offer a slightly unconventional approach, which can be seen not that often, but it worked great for me and for those who trained by the same way. As you will see in the following examples, the form does not need to be perfect from the beginning.

In all the exercises push the shoulders forward. It is important to understand that the planche (and all its variations and progressions) is a lever, so you must carry enough weight in the front to lift the legs. Better go for the elements by lean rather than a jump. That will allow you to have a better control.



#### 3.3.1. Tuck planche.

The first step. The most important is to use the shoulders technique. Here all the back will be curved. The knees are bent, positioned close to the stomach. For a complete beginner even this may seem very difficult, but in fact you can learn it fast. I recommend before that to try easier variation – 45 degree tuck planche, where that line A-A will be inclined

#### 3.3.2. Advanced tuck.

Similar to the previous one. Here the angle between the hips and the body must be 90 degrees. Also keep in mind that in the advanced tuck the line AB must be curved. Due to the position of the legs, point D will be on the same level as B and C, so try to make BC flat.





### 3.3.3. V Planch. 5

This is the progression I called "unconventional" It is great for people who already have a good handstand because there the location of the shoulders is very close to the one here. Also in V planche the shoulder pushing is more like the handstand rather than the planche. Spread widely the legs and place the arms slightly in front of the line between the two legs. From there, just slowly move forward and lift the feet an inch from the floor. In the beginning you may have leg and butt cramps, but this will disappear after 3-4 workouts if you make the necessary attempts and train split flexibility.



You may not even be able to hold this position at the beginning. No problem. In this case, you can use light jumping from your feet and go to the position V planche position multiple times without holding.

### 3.3.4. Straddle 45 degrees planche.

Very similar to V planche, but more opened and difficult. The shoulder pushing this time is closer to the planche push. It is diagonal. This time place the arms about 15-20 cm in front of the line between the two legs and push forward with the shoulders. Putting the hands more forward will allow you to straighten the body a little more than in the V planche.





### 3.3.5. Straddle with a slightly bend legs.

I recommend the upper body to be in perfect position with the legs bent town and the hips perpendicular to the arms.

### 3.3.6. Almost straddle planche.

The idea is not to go directly to the perfect straddle. Again go with the same technique of the lean as the V planche but here put the hands way more forward.



### 3.3.7. Straddle planch

Same technique as the one I already cover at “planche technique” chapter. I recommend lifting the legs after the body gets straight during the lean.





It is important for you to understand that once you reach 10 seconds straddle planche, apart the straddle attempts you should start adding to your workout full planche attempts. I will show the progressions below. Concentrating only on straddle planche will give you some strength, but not enough for a smooth progress.

I will give an example with myself. In 2013, I have been doing straddle for over 16 seconds and was still barely performing the full, simply because I did not make any full planche attempts. In contrast to me my friends were holding less straddle planche but their full was like mine, or even better, just because they were doing some full planche attempts. This leads to the thought that there is a difference between the two exercises and you can't count only on straddle planche.



3.3.8. Full 45 degrees planche.  
Same as straddle 45 degree.



3.3.9. Full with slightly bend legs.  
This is something between an advance and a full planche. I recommend the upper body to be in perfect position with the legs to be bent down.



3.3.10. Almost full planche.



### 3.3.11. Full planche.

Technique already covered at “Planche technique” chapter. I recommend lifting your legs after your body get straight during the lean.

### Additional exercises presented in the program

Additional to the main progression there are also other exercises presented in the program

### 3.3.12. Swings to tuck/advance tuck/straddle/full planche. 6

The idea is to use momentum to go to the proper form of the planche. The more advance you become the less swing and more control you will use.



### 3.3.13. Advanced frog stand.

For sure an easy one and only for total beginners. Make a lock by touching The knees to your lower arm. It perfect for getting initial shoulder strength.



**3.3.14. Straddle sit.** Rest your inner thigh to your lower arms

**3.3.15. Straddle sit leans.**  7

From the straddle sit position try to release the thighs from the arm 4-5cm. Do this multiple times in a set.



It is possible some of the variations to be easier than others even though I have showed them as harder. For example: Some people find V straddle easier than the advanced tuck just because they are flexible and have a good handstand experience.

Some transitions between the progressions.  8  9

## 4 Planche basics

In this beginner's tutorial, I would recommend repeating the warm-up exercises each time after training. That will give you enough pushing strength to make the angle  $x$  wider. But to be able to progress in all the most important parts steady, I will add 5 more exercises for the lower back, shoulders and the feel of body positioning.

### 4.1. How many sets?

Depends on the level, I have written how many in the program, but better do not go for less than 2 or more than 4

### 4.2. How many reps and how long hold?

I have always stick to the 80% rule. Which means:

For hold – if your max hold for dumbbell press is 20 seconds – do 16 seconds

For reps – if your max is 10 reps – go for 8 reps

### 4.3. How much rest between the attempts?

Rest as much as it allows you to perform the exercises properly. Usually a minute is enough.

### 4.4. Exercises:

The following 2 exercises are for developing lower back strength

#### 4.4.1. Plank

Yes, it may look easy but even now I still do it with additional weights. It is perfect for getting stronger lower back, that will prevent you from “banana” form of the planche. Try using the technique of hollowbody I explained and stay straight. I do not recommend continuing holding ones the lower back falls, because at that point you are no longer activating the body by proper way.





#### 4.4.2. Legs rays.

Another powerful lower back exercise. Put weight on the feet and lie down on the stomach on a box or something similar, so that you can bend the legs and then straighten them horizontally. What you can do is 4 sec hold at horizontal position after each rep. Use 2-3 kg per leg.



The following 2 exercises are the best for getting the angle  $x$  wide enough for a beautiful high full planche. It is important to perform them correctly otherwise you are not activating the body by proper way.

#### 4.4.3. Dumbbell hold.

Lie down on the floor on your back and take 2 dumbbells or other type of weights. Get to the position of the full planche. Do not forget to push the shoulders forward, tightening the butt and concentrate the gaze at the feet. For maximum result better make the angle  $x$  a bit smaller than it must be. You can see the position in the photo on the next page - position A. Lately I use 7.5 kg at each hand, but if you are a beginner go for 5kg. I do not recommend more than 15 kg. Better focus on a longer hold in the right position.

#### 4.4.4. Dumbbell press. 10

A transition from A to B (photo on page 23). Do not go wide but keep hands close to the body (shoulder distance) That's because maltese (wide planche) and full planche are different exercises and muscles work different way. Better go for lighter kg, no more than 7 kg and do it slowly with control.



**Position A**



**Position B**



**Position A**



**Position B**

The next exercise is for developing the feeling of body position.

#### 4.4.5. Planche with a rubber band. 11

Apart being excellent for gaining strength, this exercise is also perfect for improving the sense of positioning the body at the right level. Put the rubber band under the stomach and attach it to the bar above. Try to keep the waist just below the bar so that the rubber band can only pull you up and not diagonally. I recommend putting a camera sideways and capturing each attempt until you reach the perfection. Avoid looking at the side mirror because this can make the form worst. Use a harder elastic band, so you can focus more on the technic.



Of course, there are much more exercises, but they are not so important for a beginner. Better concentrate on less basic exercises but do them regularly and strict. The more basics you have the less focus on the actual attempts you will have, which for sure is not a good approach.



# Program

I have separated the program into 2 parts.

## 1 Straddle planche

**1.1 How often to train?** Since you are a beginner, I do not recommend training more than 3 times a week.

A good option is 7 days cycle. By this way you will have another 4 days where you can devote to other skills and rest

| Day 1   | Day 2             | Day 3   | Day 4             | Day 5   | Day 6             | Day 7             |
|---------|-------------------|---------|-------------------|---------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Planche | Rest/other skills | Planche | Rest/other skills | Planche | Rest/other skills | Rest/other skills |

## 1.2 Program sequence of the training -->

| Level | Level requirement                   |                                    | Attempts                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Base workout                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Total beginner                      | normal warm up<br>specific warm up | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>tuck planche (possible to use jumps if its hard)</li> <li>swing to tuck planche (big swing, high momentum)</li> <li>frog stand</li> <li>straddle sit</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                            | No base workout, better concentrate on attempts at first                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2     | Tuck planche - 10 sec.              |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>advanced tuck planche</li> <li>V straddle planche (only jumping with the feet, without hold to slowly start feeling it)</li> <li>tuck planche</li> <li>swings to advance tuck planche (big swing, high momentum)</li> <li>straddle sit leans (big swing, high momentum)</li> </ul>                         | <b>2 sets x</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>planche lean (supine grip) reps: 80% max</li> <li>plank</li> <li>shoulder push-ups - reps: 80% max</li> </ul>                                     |
| 3     | Advanced tuck planche - 10 sec.     |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>V straddle planche</li> <li>advance tuck planche</li> <li>tuck planche (optional, if it's too easy better concentrate on the next exercise)</li> <li>swings to advance tuck planche (less momentum, more control)</li> <li>straddle sit leans (less momentum, more control)</li> </ul>                     | <b>3 sets x</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>planche lean (supine grip) reps: 80% max</li> <li>plank</li> <li>shoulder push-ups - reps: 80% max</li> </ul>                                     |
| 4     | V straddle planche - 8 sec.         |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>45 degrees straddle planche</li> <li>V straddle planche</li> <li>advanced tuck planche</li> <li>swing to straddle planche (big swing, high momentum)</li> <li>swings to advanced planche (less momentum, more control)</li> </ul>                                                                          | <b>3 sets x</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>planche lean (supine grip)</li> <li>plank</li> <li>shoulder push-ups</li> <li>leg rays</li> </ul>                                                 |
| 5     | 45 degree straddle planche - 8 sec. |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>almost straddle planche</li> <li>45 degrees straddle planche</li> <li>V straddle planche</li> <li>advanced tuck planche</li> <li>swing to straddle planche - (big swing, high momentum)</li> <li>swings to advanced tuck planche - (less momentum, more control)</li> </ul>                                | <b>4 sets x</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>shoulder push-ups</li> <li>plank</li> <li>planche lean (supine grip)</li> <li>leg rays</li> </ul>                                                 |
| 6     | Almost straddle planche - 8 sec.    |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>straddle planche</li> <li>almost straddle planche</li> <li>straddle planche with slightly bend legs</li> <li>45 degrees straddle planche (optional)</li> <li>swing to straddle planche - (less momentum, more control)</li> <li>swings to advanced tuck planche - (less momentum, more control)</li> </ul> | <b>4 sets x</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>planche lean (supine grip)</li> <li>plank (additional weights)</li> <li>shoulder push-ups</li> <li>leg rays</li> <li>rubber band pulls</li> </ul> |

## ② Full planche

### 2.1. Training separation

The levels remaining until the end are only 4, but keep in mind that the progress time from one level to another will probably be slower than it was till level 7.

At this point, you should already consider splitting the workout into 2 parts - for form and for hold.

#### 2.1.1. For hold.

The focus is on hold. Keep holding as much as you can, and at the same time try to keep decent form. In between attempts rest that much that will allow you to do 3-4 exercise attempts with a hold which is no less than 50 percent of your max.

**Example:** If my first hold max is 10 seconds, I will rest enough so my next attempt will be more than 5 seconds. If after 3 or 4 attempts if I already hold less than 5 seconds I move on to the next exercise. Of course never do less than 4 attempts whatever the hold is.

#### 2.1.2 For form.

Only focus on the quality of the form. Try to make the shape perfect even if the hold is 2 seconds. (The equivalent of this training for a total beginner can be with performed with elastic band.)

Between the attempts you rest as much as will allow you to make perfect shape. Put your phone sideways to take videos and analyze all the details. Do not look a side at mirrors as this will affect the form.

### 2.2. How to combine training for hold and training for hold?

Usually, the training for a hold is longer and harder (with more attempts and exercises) than the one for form. I recommend training the form one day before the hold. And between hold training and the next workout for form – at least 1 day of rest. By this way you will always do your attempts for best form when you are fresh and full of energy.



## 2.3 How often to train?

At this point you can train 3-4 times a week.

Optional variants:

7 days cycle

| Day 1 | Day 2 | Day 3             | Day 4 | Day 5 | Day 6             | Day 7             |
|-------|-------|-------------------|-------|-------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Form  | Hold  | Rest/other skills | Form  | Hold  | Rest/other skills | Rest/other skills |

3 days cycle

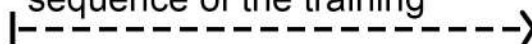
| Day 1 | Day 2 | Day 3             |
|-------|-------|-------------------|
| Form  | Hold  | Rest/other skills |

6 days cycle. Less focus on the form.

| Day 1 | Day 2 | Day 3             | Day 4 | Day 5             | Day 6             |
|-------|-------|-------------------|-------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Form  | Hold  | Rest/other skills | Hold  | Rest/other skills | Rest/other skills |

Keep in mind that the more skills you want to train the longer the cycle will be (8-9 days) and the slower the progress will be. It all depends on your goals.

## sequence of the training



| Level     | Level requirement                             | Type of training |                                    | Attempts                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Base workout                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>7</b>  | Perfect straddle planche - 8 sec.             | For form         | normal warm up<br>specific warm up | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• straddle planche – perfect form</li> <li>• straddle planche with slightly bend legs – perfect upper body position</li> <li>• straddle planche with a rubber band– perfect form</li> <li>• swing to perfect straddle planche (less momentum, more control)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                       | No base                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|           |                                               | For hold         |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• full planche with slightly band legs – max hold</li> <li>• 45 degrees full planche – max hold</li> <li>• straddle planche – max hold</li> <li>• almost straddle planche – max hold</li> <li>• straddle planche with slightly bend legs - max hold (optional)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>4 sets x</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• rubber band pulls</li> <li>• plank (with additional weights)</li> <li>• dumbbell hold</li> <li>• leg rays</li> <li>• planche lean (supine grip).</li> </ul>                                                                                                       |
| <b>8</b>  | Full planche with slightly bend legs – 8 sec. | For form         |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• full planche with slightly band legs – perfect upper body form</li> <li>• straddle planche – perfect form</li> <li>• straddle planche with slightly band legs – perfect upper body form</li> <li>• straddle planche with a rubber band– perfect form</li> <li>• swing to full planche (less momentum, more control)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                             | No base                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|           |                                               | For hold         |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• almost full planche – max hold</li> <li>• full planche with slightly band legs – max hold</li> <li>• 45 degrees full planche – max hold</li> <li>• straddle planche – max hold</li> <li>• almost straddle planche - max hold</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>4 sets x</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• rubber band pulls</li> <li>• back lever extensions</li> <li>• dumbbell hold</li> <li>• plank (additional weights)</li> <li>• rubber band pulls</li> <li>• leg rays</li> <li>• planche lean (supine grip)</li> </ul>                                               |
| <b>9</b>  | Almost full planche – 10 sec.                 | For form         |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• full planche – perfect form</li> <li>• full planche with slightly band legs – perfect upper body form</li> <li>• straddle planche – perfect form</li> <li>• full planche with a rubber band– perfect form</li> <li>• straddle planche with a rubber band– perfect form</li> <li>• swing to full planche (less momentum, more control)</li> </ul>                                                                                                           | No base                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|           |                                               | For hold         |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• full planche – max hold</li> <li>• almost full planche – max hold</li> <li>• full planche with slightly band legs – max hold</li> <li>• straddle planche – max hold</li> <li>• almost straddle planche - max hold</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>4 sets x</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• rubber band pulls</li> <li>• leg rays</li> <li>• dumbbell press</li> <li>• back lever extensions</li> <li>• dumbbell hold</li> <li>• plank (additional weights)</li> <li>• rubber band pulls</li> <li>• leg rays</li> <li>• planche lean (supine grip)</li> </ul> |
| <b>10</b> | Full planche - 10 sec.                        | For form         |                                    | Same as level 9                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | No base                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|           |                                               | For hold         |                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• full planche – max hold (with additional weights, I usually put 2 x 1.5 each leg) - 10 attempts. An option is to combine it with front lever done right after the planche attempt</li> <li>• full planche – max hold – no weights, 10 attempts</li> <li>• straddle planche max hold (additional weights) – 10 attempts</li> <li>• straddle planche max hold – no weights, 10 attempts</li> </ul> <p>No need to practice the easiest variations anymore</p> | <b>4 sets x</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Same as level 9 but with higher amount of reps</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                         |



## **3 About the program**

### **3.1. From what level to start?**

If you met the minimum requirements of a certain level, then you are ready for that level. Once you find your level, work on it till you meet the requirements of the next level.

### **3.2. How much time need to progress from level to level?**

Varies from person to person. That is why I never put a time limit. It is normal to progress fast in the beginning and then to slow down. Do not worry and keep training. There are always ups and downs. There will be days or even weeks where you will make no progress. At those bad days do your best to make the same hold and quality as the previous workout and add one more set on the basics.

### **3.3. About the warm up.**

For all the Levels do 10-15 minutes regular warm up and 10 minutes special planche warm up (leans, rubber band pulls and shoulder push-ups) Warm up till the pain disappears and you feel comfortable to planche.

### **3.4. About the attempts.**

Try to do all the attempts into the numerical sequences. Do at least 4 attempts of each variation/exercise or till you cannot perform it anymore and then move to the next one.

### **3.5. About the basics.**

Better go for super sets rather than doing all the sets of one basic exercise and then move on to the next one. That is valid for all the levels.

### **3.6. Take notes.**

I recommend you start writing the performance quality and the seconds of your holds in a notebook. Try to make them slightly better the next planche training. In 2016, I started doing this and progressed much faster. Since then, I have written over 4-5 notebooks, according to which I have structured the program below.

## ■ Most common mistakes?

### **Rushing.**

One of the biggest mistakes is to hurry. I often see this in young athletes imitating their idols and trying to perform the most complex elements without initial preparation.

When I started, the highest level was the one of Hannibal for King and Dennis Minin. To some extent, it reflected well on my growth as an athlete, because my goal for 2012-2013 was far below what young athletes put themselves now (like trying to go for maltese without having basic strength) So pay attention to basic requirements, and consider whether you are strong enough to planche. Never skip the steps. Make sure you passed a level 100% before moving to the next one. Its sounds like a slow process but in fact it is way better than reaching a high level fast and then stopping for a while because of an injury.

### **Workout without hollow body.**

Leads to "banana" form of the planche. Do not activate the muscles by proper way.

### **Not enough exercise/training too much.**

So how often you should train? It mainly depends on the level you are, but for a beginner I recommend no more than 4 and no less than 2 times a week.

I as a beginner was impatient and wanted to get strong as soon as possible, training almost every day. My progress was slow. At one point, I started training 3-4 times a week and I as a result I got faster progress.

## ■ Most common questions.

### **Will the process be painful? How about injuries?**

Of course, pain is part of the progress. However, we need to make difference between 2 types of pain.

One is due to injury. In most cases, you must keep training, but replace the planche attempts with basic exercises which imitate the planche. That will benefit for not losing your gains. Even the healing process will be faster if you exercise rather than doing a total rest. The biggest injury I had was on my wrist in 2015. I could not do one arm handstand for 6 months. During this time, I did not stop training even though doctors said me to do so. I just replaced the one-handed stand with the little regular handstand attempts and a lot of mobility.

The other pain is more common. People often get confused and think its injury, but the real reason is that they have not warmed up well or they have some muscle imbalance that must be fixed with a help of kinesiotherapy. I used to have that problem in summer 2020.



### **How long will it take to learn it?**

There are a few major factors that this depends on: Two of the factors are the training intensity (how often you train) and the initial preparation. I already covered both. Another factor are the genetics. I do not deny that genetics plays a big role. Is the planche easier for shorter guys? In most cases yes, but there is one more important thing - the proportions of the hands to the body. This can be seen from my explanation at "Planche height" chapter. Also there are people genetically much more powerful in pushing force rather than in pulling, and of course the opposite. But in the end hard work beats genetics, so there are no excuses!

Ultimately some people take two months to learn that skill, while others need years.

### **Will I ruin my planche progress if I squat?**

Of course not, but you need to reschedule your training program. For those who squat or plan to start squatting soon, I recommend at least a day rest between leg training and planche workout. That is especially if you are new in the planche game. I started squatting when I already had a really stable planche, but I still had struggle with the legs squeezing during performing planche after a legs day. So imagine how much harder for a beginner will be.

### **Do I need to train flexibility?**

In the calisthenics and gymnastics there are few girls who are close to straddle planche. Of course it is because they are strong, but not only. In most cases, they have a very good split flexibility, which shortens the body and makes the skill easier. So if you are new to planche you can add some split flexibility in the end of your training. That will make your progress faster. Sadly, it does not work for the full planche.

Also shoulder flexibility is a must. Years of strength will stiff your shoulders. That will make them more vulnerable to injuries. Also some of the elements like proper planche press, entrada de angel and others will become harder and more painful to perform.

### **How about the diets?**

Diets are important but the more important is the way you train. Do not get obsessed from diets and weight measurements. Avoid low-quality food and overeating. It is that simple.

## ■ Conclusion

Ultimately, I want to say something important that always work for me and makes each attempt way better. Always visualize, even from the beginning think about yourself like you already achieved the planche. Before each attempt visualize how you do the perfect form, and even though you are still far away from it, your mind will be on the right direction, totally focused on the aim. Another strong mind trick is to say to yourself that if you do that perfect attempt, something you really want to happen will become a fact. That is what I have done, and what I still do. And trust me, it works. That is how I have achieved 36 seconds of full planche.

It is also important to mention in the end that each person is different. The program is perfect for me, but probably not for everybody. It usually varies from person to person, depending on the genetics and the different strong or weak body parts. What is more valuable than the program are the overall training approach and techniques, which are always the same for everybody. Feel free to DM me on Instagram (viktor\_kamenov) I will be happy to answer your questions and check your progress and feedback. Wish you good luck, stay healthy and always train smart!



## Equipment used in the program

If you want to get the products I used in the program you have a chance for **10% discount** by using my promo codes.

The discount is available for all the products of the 2 big leaders - **Pullup-dip** and **Gornation**. Those brands have proven themselves for providing the best professional high quality calisthenics equipment.

### 1 Pullup-dip

#### Wooden Parallettes

In this e-book the brand is represented by the wooden parallettes.

The specially developed ergonomic wooden handle protects your wrists and offers you a perfect grip during planche performance. The feet are made of high-quality steel, including anti-slip pads, which ensures a safe and firm footing with every exercise.



Pullup-dip also offers a big variety of calisthenics equipment  
Use **"KAMENOV10"** for **10% discount** on all their products  
at [www.pullup-dip.com](http://www.pullup-dip.com)

## 2 Gornation

Gornation is known with its high-quality clothes and calisthenic equipment. Use **“VKAMENOV”** for **10% discount** on all their products at [www.gornation.com](http://www.gornation.com)  
In this e-book they are represented by the resistance bands and the clothes I wear

